Nước chấm

Vietnamese garlic, lime and fish sauce dip, kept strong

Makes about 250 ml (1 cup) · **Prep** 10 min

> *Draft method for David to check. The vault note lists only the ingredients, so the method is worked out from them and hasn't been tested.*

This version has no water, so it is stronger than most: use it as is for spooning over rice and grilled meat, or thin it for a dipping sauce (see Notes). Dissolve the sugar fully before tasting.

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tbsp granulated sugar
- 4 tbsp lime juice (about 2 limes)
- 6 tbsp fish sauce
- 6 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tsp chili garlic sauce

METHOD

1. **Dissolve the sugar.** Stir the sugar into the lime juice until it has dissolved. Warming the juice for a few seconds helps.
2. **Add the rest.** Stir in the fish sauce, garlic and chili garlic sauce.
3. **Taste and rest.** Taste for the balance of salty, sour and sweet, adding a little more lime or sugar if needed. Leave it for 10 minutes so the garlic flavours the sauce.

NOTES

- For a classic dipping sauce for spring rolls or bún, stir in 60–120 ml (¼–½ cup) warm water.
- Keeps for about a week in the fridge; the garlic gets stronger as it sits.